

The half-carved Dhauli elephant, cut into the top of the rock on which a set of Ashoka’s major rock edicts are incised. It was carved in about 259 BCE, making it one of the earliest stone sculptures of India’s historical age. Detail of a photograph taken in 1895 by Alexander Caddy of the ASI, whose pitched canvas tent can be seen in the background.



Mark Shand, champion of the Indian elephant, here seen with the elephant Tara and mahout at the Jain rock-cut caves at Udayagiri,